KNICKS TITLE DEFENSE · DATA STORY

THE REPEAT TEST

12 of 46 NBA champions since 1980 have repeated. On ring night, the Knicks start their shot at being the 13th.

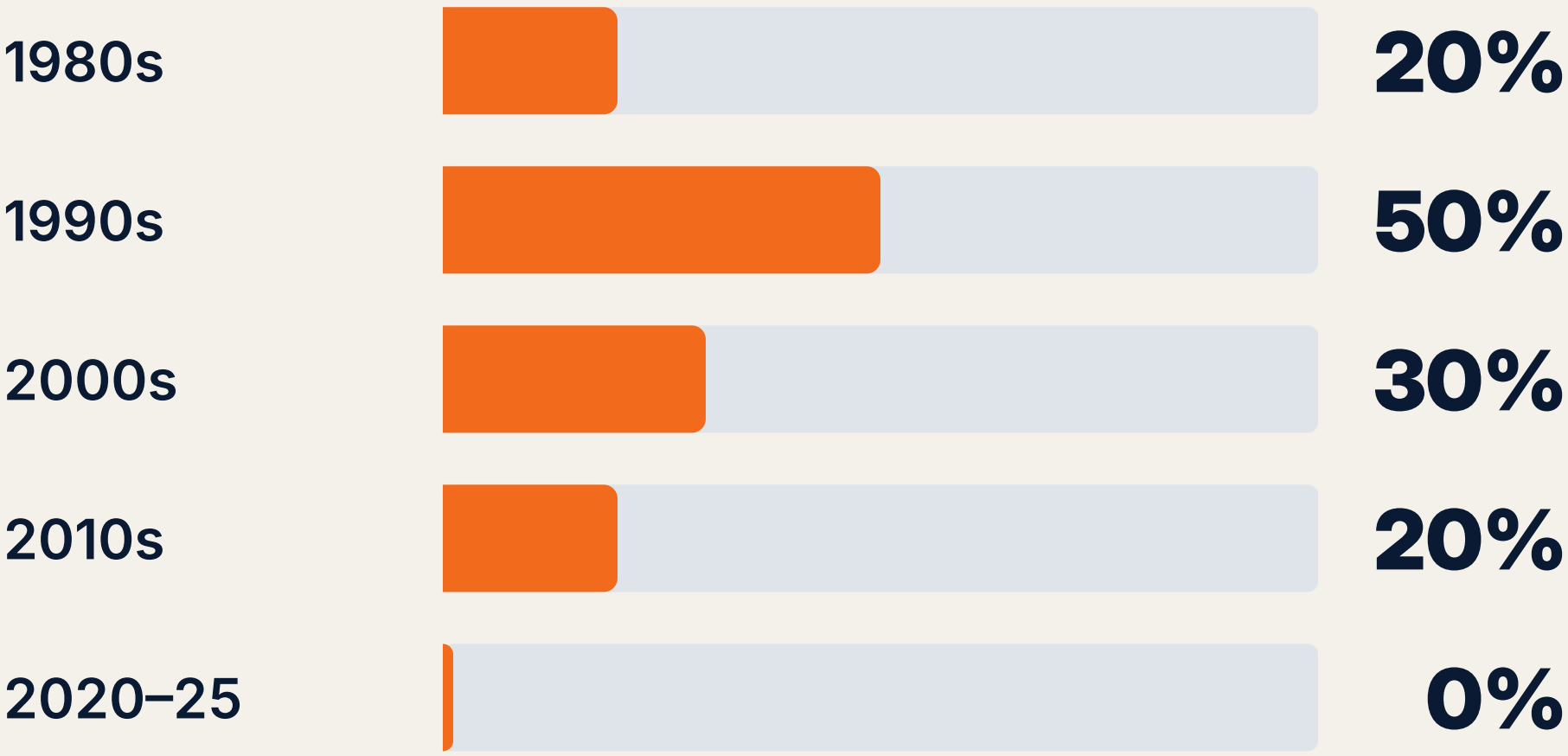
Colin Spelman

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STORY 01

REPEATING HAS NEVER BEEN HARDER

Share of defending champions who repeated, by the decade of the title they were defending.



2020s champions are 0-for-6. Last repeat: Warriors, 2017–18.

STORY 02

RUNNING IT BACK, UNDER THE APRON

The starting five (~$192M) stayed intact without crossing the ~$222M second apron. The trade-off: frontcourt depth.

KEPT / ADDED

Starting five
all back

Landry Shamet
4 yr, ~$24M

Jose Alvarado
3 yr, ~$14.4M

Mohamed Diawara
4 yr, ~$11.3M

Clarkson · Drummond
min · signed

LOST

Mitchell Robinson
→ Celtics, 3 yr, $47.4M.
Longest-tenured Knick

Ariel Hukporti
→ 76ers, 1 yr, $3.4M

STORY 03

16–3: THE RUN IN NUMBERS

ROUND 1

4–2

vs. Hawks

EAST SEMIS

4–0

vs. 76ers

EAST FINALS

4–0

vs. Cavaliers

NBA FINALS

4–1

vs. Spurs

WIN STREAK

11

straight playoff wins

BRUNSON, G5

45

points · Finals MVP

Every Finals game was within 5 points in the last 5 minutes, a first in the play-by-play era.

STORY 04

THE CHAMPION'S PREMIUM

Average opening-week ticket price.

Knicks **$1,212**

NBA average **$326**

≈ **3.7×** the league average, 2nd only to the 76ers.

EVERY MONDAY · STARTS OCT 26

THE REPEAT TRACKER

This year's Knicks vs. the title team, on five metrics.

1	Win pace	title team **53–29**
2	Point differential	title team **+6.3**
3	Clutch record	Finals **4–1**
4	Frontcourt rebounding	without **Robinson**
5	Starting-five workload	the **$192M** core

YOUR TURN

WHAT'S THE SIXTH METRIC?

Comment what you'd track. The best idea joins next Monday's Repeat Tracker.

Follow along every Monday this season.

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Independent project; not affiliated with the NBA or the New York Knicks. Data: StatMuse, NBA.com, ESPN, Eurohoops, FOX 5 NY.